

Cohen Talks Of Hanging It Up

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baseball Coach Andy Cohen has apparently decided to hang up his jersey after the Miners conclude the 1978

season Saturday.

Although Cohen said he will not announce a decision until he talks to UTEP Athletic Director Jim Bowden early next week, Cohen has hinted strongly that he'll resign his post which he has held since baseball was first introduced at UTEP in 1963.

"The fun isn't there now like it used to be," said Cohen recently. "It's for that reason that I'm seriously thinking about retiring. I can't even hit in-field balls anymore and maybe it's time for some new life to come into the program."

Cohen's attempts to turn UTEP's baseball program into a Western Athletic Conference contender so that the Miners could compete along the same lines with Arizona and Arizona State have shown little progress.

Cohen is currently in his 16th season at UTEP after playing several years of professional ball. Cohen has claimed to be the winningest manager percentage-wise in the major leagues.

"I had retired from baseball in 1959 but in 1960, I was called to coach at Philadelphia," recalled Cohen. "Eddie Sawyer was the manager and had been for several years. I guess he saw that Philadelphia wasn't going to have a good team because he resigned before the 1960 season began.

"I was appointed manager for opening day. I'll never forget it. We beat Milwaukee in 10 innings 5-4."

Unfortunately, Cohen was not as successful on the college level. Before Friday night's game against the New Mexico Lobos, Cohen's overall record at UTEP was 300 victories against 351 defeats and two ties.

Cohen began his baseball career in 1925 when he signed with Waco in the Texas League directly after he left the University of Alabama. A year later, Cohen was sold to the New York Giants for \$25,000 and another player.

After two years with the Giants, he was optioned to Buffalo of the International League before reporting back to the Giants in 1928.

In 1930, Cohen was traded to Newark, N.J. which was in the International League. In 1932, Cohen was traded to Minneapolis of the American Association where he played for nine years.

From Minneapolis, Cohen went down to be a player-manager of Pinebluff, Ark., a farm team of the Dodgers. In 1941, he managed Dayton of the Mis-Atlantic League and then went up to Eau Claire, Wis., to manage the team in the Northern League for three years.

Cohen's managerial duties shifted to Denver where he stayed from 1951-55 before heading to New Orleans to lead up to Indianapolis before returning to Denver in 1958 after the New York Yankees promoted Ralph Houk to manage the Yanks.

Cohen stayed with Philadelphia until he took the UTEP job in 1963.



UTEP'S ANDY COHEN

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